

Answer Keys, Rubrics & Next Steps

Everything you need to score Progress Test 1 (Class 13) and the Final Test (Class 24): answers and point values, acceptable alternatives, the errors to expect, CEFR-aligned speaking and writing rubrics, what the scores mean for each learner's next class, and how to give the news kindly.

Progress Test 1 /70

Final Test /100

Rubric bands: Not yet A1 • A1 • A1+

Confidential • teacher only

SCORING PRINCIPLES

Score meaning, not spelling, in Listening and Reading: an answer that shows understanding gets the point, even if it is misspelled ("sicks o'clock" for *six o'clock* is correct). In Vocabulary, the word must be recognizable, so a small spelling slip (*chiar*) earns the point, but a different word does not. Grammar items are circle-only, so they are either right or wrong. Speaking and extended writing use the rubrics. Half points are not used.

AT A GLANCE

SECTION	PROGRESS TEST 1 (MODULES 1-4)	FINAL TEST (MODULES 1-8)
 Listening	12 items • 1 pt each • /12	15 items • 1 pt each • /15
 Vocabulary	10 pictures • /10	12 pictures + 3 odd-one-out • /15
 Grammar	15 items • /15	20 items • /20
 Reading	6 yes/no + 2 short answers • /8	8 yes/no + 7 menu questions • /15
 Writing	Form 5 + 3 sentences 5 • /10	Form 8 + "My week" rubric 12 • /20
 Speaking	Pair task, rubric 5 × 0-3 • /15	Interview, rubric 5 × 0-3 • /15
Total	/70 (written /55)	/100 (written /85)

PROGRESS TEST 1 • ANSWER KEY

◆ PART 1 • LISTENING /12

1 15 fifteen: stress on *-TEEN*

◆ PART 2 • VOCABULARY /10

1 pen 6 fish

2	30	thirty: stress on <i>THIR</i> -
3	67	sixty-seven
4	078 442 190	"oh" = 0, "double four"
5	KARIM	any case; all 5 letters in order
6	JONES	any case; all 5 letters in order
7	umbrella	picture 1
8	grandfather	picture 3
9	sofa	picture 3
10	Mexico	
11	32	
12	swim	picture 2 (she <i>can</i> cook and sing)

2	cup	7	chair
3	apple	8	bed
4	egg	9	window
5	bread	10	kitchen

Accept *an apple* / *an egg* / *a pen* (article added). Accept a recognizable slip (*kichen*). Plural forms (*eggs*) are fine.

◆ PART 4 • READING / 8

1	Yes	5	Yes
2	No	6	Yes
3	No	7	At six (o'clock) / 6:00 / six
4	No	8	(She's) eight / 8

◆ PART 3 • GRAMMAR /15 • WITH THE LESSON TO REVISIT

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
1	am	I → am	2.1
2	are	they → are; <i>is</i> is the common error	2.1
3	an	<i>orange</i> starts with a vowel sound	2.2
4	These	plural + near	2.2
5	His	owner = brother (a man)	2.3
6	Her	owner = Anna. The noun <i>mother</i> doesn't decide it. Tagalog, Chinese, and Turkish speakers often mix these up.	2.3
7	don't	I → don't	3.1
8	works	he/she/it + -s	3.2
9	Do	you → Do	3.1
10	doesn't	he → doesn't + base verb	3.2
11	are	two + plural noun	3.3
12	any	questions → any	3.3
13	at	clock times → at	3.2

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
14	swim	can + base verb (no -s, no to, no -ing)	4.1
15	are watching	Look! ... now → present continuous	4.2

◆ PART 5 • WRITING /10

- ◆ **A. Form (5 × 1 pt).** One point per box that has the right *kind* of information: a name in the name boxes, a country (not a nationality) under Country, digits under Phone, something with @ and a dot under Email. Names and country need a **capital letter** for the point. Invented details score the same as real ones.
- ◆ **B. Three sentences (5 pts).** +1 for each sentence (max 3) that is an understandable sentence about the writer, with a subject and a verb (*I from Syria* = 0; *I am from Syria* = 1). +1 if all sentences start with a capital letter and end with a period. +1 if the verb forms are correct in at least two sentences (*I have two children, I get up at 6, I can cook*).

Model answer (5/5): I am from Colombia. I live in a small flat with my son. I can cook, but I can't drive.

◆ ERRORS TO EXPECT (PROGRESS TEST 1)

- ◆ **13 vs 30, 15 vs 50** in Part 1A. The stress pattern is the whole clue, so drill it again in a warmer.
- ◆ **G/J and E/I** when spelling names (1B). Spanish and French speakers often swap them, so recycle the alphabet chant.
- ◆ **"I have 32 years"** in speaking (Spanish, Portuguese, French, Arabic L1). Recycle *I'm 32 (years old)*.
- ◆ **Dropped be:** "I from Egypt" (Arabic, Chinese, Russian L1). This shows up in Part 5B and in speaking.
- ◆ **his/her** (item 5–6), **third-person -s** (8, 10), and **can to / can swims** (14). These are the three most common grammar misses at this point.

FINAL TEST • ANSWER KEY

◆ PART 1 • LISTENING /15

1	3:30	9	nurse
2	3 May	10	coat
3	Tuesday	11	a coffee
4	\$12.50	12	milk
5	7:45	13	cheese
6	umbrella	14	Take away
7	tea	15	\$6.50

◆ PART 2 • VOCABULARY /15

1	banana	7	teacher
2	cheese	8	chef
3	sandwich	9	driver
4	cake	10	jacket
5	lamp	11	trousers
6	fridge	12	boots
13	July	a month; the others are days	

8	foot		
14	bread	food; the others are clothes	
15	kitchen	a room; the others are family	

Picture positions: 6 = middle, 7 = right, 8 = left, 9 = right, 10 = middle.

Accept *pants* for 11 and *cook* for 8 (both are real alternatives, even though they aren't in the box).

◆ PART 3 • GRAMMAR / 20 • WITH THE LESSON TO REVISIT

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
1	are	we → are	2.1
2	an	<i>umbrella</i> starts with a vowel sound	2.2
3	brother's	possessive 's	2.3
4	gets up	he + -s on the verb, not the particle	3.2
5	Does	she → Does + base verb	3.2
6	is	one sofa	3.3
7	drive	can't + base verb	4.1
8	is sleeping	<i>Shh!</i> = right now	4.2
9	children	irregular plural	5.1
10	red bag	adjective before noun, no plural -s	5.1
11	in	inside the bag	5.2
12	Have	you → Have ... got	5.3
13	has	he → has got	5.3
14	am never	adverb after <i>be</i>	6.1
15	cooking	love + -ing	6.2
16	in	months → in	6.3
17	am going to	<i>be</i> is needed (a common drop)	6.3
18	any	question → any	7.1
19	many	eggs = countable	7.1
20	should	should + base verb (no <i>to</i>)	8.1

1	No	"It's small"
2	Yes	
3	No	in a café
4	No	Monday to Friday
5	Yes	
6	Yes	
7	No	on Saturday
8	Yes	"Would you like to have lunch...?"
9	\$2.00	accept "two dollars", "2"
10	\$7.00	
11	No	
12	Yes	orange juice
13	\$1.50	accept "one fifty"
14	\$6.00	2.50 + 3.50
15	any menu item	e.g. "a cheese sandwich". The item must be on the menu. The article is optional.

- ◆ **A. Form (8 × 1 pt).** Same rule as the progress test. Country vs nationality must be the right type (*Mexico / Mexican*). The birthday needs a day and a month in any clear format (*3 May, May 3, 3/5*). For Job, accept "student", "at home", "I don't work", or a job title.
- ◆ **B. My week (12).** Score with the **writing rubric** below: four criteria × 0–3.

Model answer (A1+, 12/12): Every day I get up at six and take the bus to work. I usually cook dinner, but I never cook on Fridays. I love walking in the park. I can speak Arabic and a little English. In my home there are two bedrooms and a small kitchen. Next week I'm going to visit my cousin.

◆ ERRORS TO EXPECT (FINAL TEST)

- ◆ **Items 4, 5, 13,** the he/she forms (*gets, Does, has*), stay the most frequent misses at A1 exit. It's normal, and A2 recycles them.
- ◆ **"I never am late"** (14), **"I going to"** (17), **"How much eggs"** (19), **"should to"** (20).
- ◆ **Listening 2:** *third vs thirteenth vs thirtieth*. **Listening 5:** *quarter to* is often read as *quarter past*. Accept only the right answer, but note it as a next step.
- ◆ **Writing:** *I like cook* (no -ing), *There is two...*, a missing *be* in *I'm going to*, lowercase *i* and lowercase days.

SPEAKING RUBRIC · BOTH TESTS

Five criteria, each 0–3 (total /15). 0 = no response, or only L1. The bands follow the CEFR qualitative aspects of spoken language (range, accuracy, fluency, interaction, phonological control). The A1 column paraphrases the Council of Europe's A1 descriptors (*CEFR Companion Volume*, 2020). For the progress test, judge against Modules 1–4 language only.

CRITERION	NOT YET A1 (1)	A1 (2)	A1+ STRONG (3)
Task & social language /3	Answers some prompts with single words or gestures; greetings or goodbyes are missing or need a model.	Handles every stage with memorized phrases: greets, introduces self, gives personal details, and uses <i>please / thank you / I'd like</i> in the role-play.	Completes every stage and adds something without being asked (a reason, a second detail, a follow-up question).
Range (words) /3	Very few words. Gaps stop the task, and the learner falls back on L1 or pointing.	A basic repertoire of words and simple phrases for personal details and familiar, concrete situations (home, food, routine, clothes).	Enough words to vary answers. Can say the same thing another way when a word is missing.
Accuracy (grammar) /3	Few correct patterns. Often drops <i>be</i> or the verb, so the meaning is often unclear.	Limited control of a few simple structures from a learned repertoire (<i>I'm..., I have..., I can..., There is...</i>). Errors are frequent but the meaning is usually clear.	Mostly correct basic patterns, including <i>he/she -s, going to</i> , and <i>like + -ing</i> (final test). Errors rarely affect meaning.
Interaction /3	Answers only when helped. Cannot ask a question, even from the card.	Asks and answers simple questions on familiar topics. Relies on repetition, a slower pace, and help, and can ask for it (<i>Sorry? Slowly, please.</i>).	Asks questions naturally, keeps the exchange going, and repairs a breakdown alone.
Pronunciation & fluency /3	Often hard to understand, even for a teacher who knows the learner. Long silences.	Learned words and phrases can be understood with some effort. Short, mainly pre-packaged utterances with pauses to search for words.	Easy to understand for a sympathetic listener. Short turns flow with few long pauses, and numbers and times are clear.

WRITING RUBRIC · FINAL TEST PART 5B

Four criteria, each 0–3 (total /12). 0 = nothing written, or nothing in English. At A1 the learner can fill in forms with personal details and write simple, isolated phrases and sentences about themselves (paraphrased from the CEFR).

CRITERION	NOT YET A1 (1)	A1 (2)	A1+ STRONG (3)
Task /3	1–2 sentences, or words and phrases that aren't sentences. Mostly copied from the prompts.	4–6 simple sentences about the writer's week that follow most prompts.	All 6 prompts covered, with some extra detail (time words, <i>and</i> / <i>but</i>).
Range /3	Repeats the same few words.	Basic words for routine, likes, home, and plans.	Some variety: frequency adverbs, several activities, <i>next week</i> / <i>tomorrow</i> .
Accuracy /3	Most sentences lack a verb or <i>be</i> , and the meaning is often unclear.	Simple patterns mostly correct (<i>I get up...</i> , <i>I can...</i> , <i>There are...</i>). Errors in <i>-ing</i> , <i>going to</i> , and adverb position.	Nearly all sentences are correct, including <i>like</i> + <i>-ing</i> , <i>going to</i> , and adverb position.
Spelling & punctuation /3	Many words hard to recognize; no capitals or periods.	Familiar words spelled well enough to read; capital <i>I</i> and sentence capitals mostly used.	Few slips; capitals for <i>I</i> , names, and days; periods throughout.

WHAT THE SCORES MEAN

◆ PROGRESS TEST 1 (/70): A DIAGNOSIS, NOT A VERDICT

SCORE	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	WHAT TO DO IN WEEKS 7–12
56–70	Strong. Modules 1–4 are secure.	Give the stretch task in every lesson. Pair with a learner who needs support, as a helper, not a teacher.
42–55	On track, with gaps in one or two sections.	Point the learner to the online lessons behind their missed items (use the lesson column above). Recycle those points in warmers.
28–41	Needs targeted support.	A short one-to-one: which part felt hard? Agree on two online lessons to redo with 🎧 Listen. Use the literacy-support options in every class. Check attendance.
0–27	Something is getting in the way.	Talk privately and gently. Check vision, hearing, literacy in L1 and in the Latin alphabet, attendance, and life stress. Consider a literacy class alongside this one, or re-checking level with the shared placement test . Keep them in the class and keep them welcome.

Class analysis: add up each section for the whole class and divide by the number of learners. A section average under 60% is a class problem, not an individual one. Build a 5–10 minute recycle into the warmers of Classes 14–19 (for example, a numbers bingo if Part 1A is weak, or a *his/her* photo chain if item 5–6 is weak).

◆ FINAL TEST (/100): GRADE TO OUTCOME

OUTCOME	GUIDELINE	WHAT TO TELL THE LEARNER AND PROGRAM
Ready for A2	70+ total and Speaking 10+/15 (mostly A1 or A1+ on the rubric).	Recommend Everyday English (A2 Elementary) . Learners at 88+ with Speaking 13+ are strong A1+ and can move quickly through the first A2 module.
A2 with a review plan	55–69 total with Speaking 8+, or 70+ with Speaking 8–9.	Move on to A2 with a written review plan : the 3–4 A1 online lessons behind their weakest items (see the lesson column), done with 🎧 Listen before A2 Week 3.
Repeat A1 with support	Below 55 total, or Speaking 7 or below.	Recommend a second lap of A1, framed as consolidation and not failure ("The second time is faster and easier."). Add literacy support, a conversation group, or a volunteer tutor if your program has them.
Literacy pathway	Speaking 10+ and Listening 11+/15, but Reading + Writing under 18/35.	Oral English is ready for A2 and literacy is the barrier. Don't hold them back for literacy alone. Recommend A2 plus a literacy class or tutor. If A2 can't support low-literate learners, repeat A1 with a literacy focus and say clearly why.

These are **guidelines**. Your twelve weeks of observation count as much as one test on one day. A learner who was ill, anxious, or grieving on test day deserves a re-test or a quick re-check with the shared placement test before any "repeat" recommendation. Record the outcome and a one-line reason for your program.

GIVING FEEDBACK KINDLY

◆ PRINCIPLES

- ◆ **Private, always.** Never read scores aloud or return papers in score order.
- ◆ **Strength first, then one next step.** One concrete step, not a list of errors.
- ◆ **Name the progress.** Compare with Week 1, not with classmates.
- ◆ **Simple English, plus L1 if you share it.** Say the key message twice and check that it landed: "Next class: A2 or A1?"
- ◆ **Written note to take home,** because family members may help read it.
- ◆ **Adults decide.** Offer the recommendation and the reason, and let the learner choose when the program allows it.

◆ PHRASES THAT WORK AT A1

Great job! 🌟

Your listening is very good.

You can order in a café now!

Practice this: he **works**, she **gets up**.

Do Lesson 3.2 at home. Click 🎧 Listen.

Next class: Everyday English (A2). 🎉

One more A1 class. It's easier the second time.

I'm proud of you.

SAY: *Twelve weeks ago you said "hello". Today you talked to a doctor in English!*

SAY: *Your speaking is ready. Reading and writing need more time. Let's find a reading class too.*

AVOID

Red ink everywhere, percentages without meaning ("62%"), the word "fail", comparisons ("Maria got 90"), and correcting a learner's L1 accent as though it were an error. If a learner cries or goes quiet, pause the conversation and come back to it. The number can wait.